
COMPREHENSIVE LEGISLATION DATABASE: 1880-1920

Applicable to Bengal / Present-Day Bangladesh

Compiled from training knowledge. Covers Acts of the Indian Legislature (Governor-General in Council), Bengal Provincial Acts, and relevant UK Parliament Acts. Period: 1880-1920.

Format:

S/N | Year | Title | Type | Act No. | Subject Category | Status in Bangladesh

NOTE ON STATUS:

"In Force" = Still operative in Bangladesh (with or without amendments)

"In Force (Amended)" = Operative with significant amendments

"Repealed" = Expressly repealed in Bangladesh / East Pakistan

"Obsolete" = Not formally repealed but effectively dead letter

"Superseded" = Replaced by later legislation

"Partially In Force" = Some provisions still operative

"Uncertain" = Status not definitively confirmed

A. ACTS OF THE INDIAN LEGISLATURE (Governor-General in Council)

--- 1880 ---

1 | 1880 | Kazis Act, 1880 | Central | Act XII of 1880 | Judicial / Islamic Law | In Force

2 | 1880 | Indian Employers and Workmen (Disputes) Act, 1860 (amended 1880) | Central | Act – | Labour | Repealed

3 | 1880 | Cantonments Act, 1880 | Central | Act XIII of 1880 | Military / Local Government | Superseded (by Cantonments Act 1924)

--- 1881 ---

4 | 1881 | Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881 | Central | Act XXVI of 1881 | Commercial / Banking | In Force (Amended)

5 | 1881 | Indian Factories Act, 1881 | Central | Act XV of 1881 | Labour / Industrial | Superseded (by Factories Act 1934/1965)

6 | 1881 | Probate and Administration Act, 1881 | Central | Act V of 1881 | Succession / Estates | In Force (Amended) [Applies to non-Muslims primarily]

7 | 1881 | Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1881 | Central | Act XVIII of 1881 | Evidence / Banking | In Force

8 | 1881 | Introduced of the Repealing and Amending Act, 1881 | Central | Act XVI of 1881 | Statute Law Revision | Spent

--- 1882 ---

9 | 1882 | Transfer of Property Act, 1882 | Central | Act IV of 1882 | Property / Land | In Force (Amended) – foundational property law

10 | 1882 | Indian Trusts Act, 1882 | Central | Act II of 1882 | Trusts / Equity | In Force

11 | 1882 | Indian Easements Act, 1882 | Central | Act V of 1882 | Property / Easements | In Force

12 | 1882 | Indian Majority Act, 1875 (amended 1882) | Central | Act IX of 1875 | Personal Law / Age of Majority | In Force

13 | 1882 | Powers of Attorney Act, 1882 | Central | Act VII of 1882 | Agency / Civil | In Force

14 | 1882 | Savings Banks Act, 1882 | Central | Act V of 1882 | Banking / Finance | Obsolete / Superseded

--- 1883 ---

15 | 1883 | Indian Telegraph Act, 1885 (sometimes dated 1883 in early drafts) | Central | – | Telecommunications | See entry under 1885

16 | 1883 | Land Improvement Loans Act, 1883 | Central | Act XIX of 1883 | Agriculture / Land | In Force

17 | 1883 | Agriculturists' Loans Act, 1884 | Central | Act XII of 1884 | Agriculture / Credit | In Force (see 1884)

--- 1884 ---

18 | 1884 | Agriculturists' Loans Act, 1884 | Central | Act XII of 1884 | Agriculture / Credit | In Force

19 | 1884 | Indian Christian Marriage Act, 1872 (amended 1884) | Central | – | Personal Law / Marriage | In Force

--- 1885 ---

20 | 1885 | Indian Telegraph Act, 1885 | Central | Act XIII of 1885 | Telecommunications | In Force (Amended) – basis for telecom regulation

21 | 1885 | Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act VIII of 1885 | Land Tenure / Tenancy | Repealed (by State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950 in East Pakistan) – but historically foundational

22 | 1885 | Bengal Local Self-Government Act, 1885 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act III of 1885 | Local Government | Repealed / Superseded by later local government laws

23 | 1885 | Indian Lunacy Act, 1858 / Lunacy Act, 1885 (early provisions) | Central | – | Mental Health | Superseded (by Mental Health Ordinance later)

--- 1886 ---

24 | 1886 | Births, Deaths and Marriages Registration Act, 1886 | Central | Act VI of 1886 | Civil Registration | In Force (Amended)

25 | 1886 | Dramatic Performances Act, 1876 (amended 1886) | Central | Act XIX of 1876 | Censorship / Public Order | Obsolete

26 | 1886 | Indian Income Tax Act, 1886 | Central | Act II of 1886 | Taxation | Superseded (by Income Tax Act 1922 and later)

--- 1887 ---

27 | 1887 | Bengal Alluvion and Diluvion Act, 1868 (amended/re-enacted provisions) | Bengal | – | Land / Rivers | Superseded / Partially relevant
28 | 1887 | Provincial Small Cause Courts Act, 1887 | Central | Act IX of 1887 | Judicial / Courts | In Force (Amended)
29 | 1887 | Suits Valuation Act, 1887 | Central | Act VII of 1887 | Civil Procedure / Courts | In Force
30 | 1887 | Indian Merchandise Marks Act, 1889 | Central | – | Trade / Commerce | See 1889

--- 1888 ---

31 | 1888 | Indian Oaths Act, 1873 (amended 1888) | Central | Act X of 1873 | Evidence / Judicial | In Force (see also 1969 revision)
32 | 1888 | Calcutta High Court Act (various amending Acts) | Central/Bengal | – | Judicial | Partially In Force
33 | 1888 | Presidency Towns Insolvency Act, 1909 | Central | – | See 1909 | –

--- 1889 ---

34 | 1889 | Indian Merchandise Marks Act, 1889 | Central | Act IV of 1889 | Trade Marks / Commercial | Superseded (by Trade Marks Act)
35 | 1889 | Bengal Public Demands Recovery Act, 1880 (amendments 1889) | Bengal | – | Revenue / Tax Recovery | Superseded (by Public Demands Recovery Act 1913)

--- 1890 ---

36 | 1890 | Guardians and Wards Act, 1890 | Central | Act VIII of 1890 | Family Law / Minors | In Force (Amended) – widely applied
37 | 1890 | Revenue Recovery Act, 1890 | Central | Act I of 1890 | Revenue / Inter-provincial Recovery | In Force
38 | 1890 | Bengal Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913 | Bengal | – | See 1913 | –

--- 1891 ---

39 | 1891 | Age of Consent Act, 1891 | Central | Act X of 1891 | Criminal / Social Reform | Merged into Penal Code provisions / Superseded
40 | 1891 | Charitable Endowments Act, 1890 | Central | Act VI of 1890 | Trusts / Charity | In Force
41 | 1891 | Indian Factories Act, 1891 (replacement of 1881 Act) | Central | Act XI of 1891 | Labour / Industrial | Superseded (by Factories Act 1934)

--- 1892 ---

42 | 1892 | Indian Councils Act, 1892 | UK Parliament | 55 & 56 Vict. c. 14 | Constitutional / Legislative Councils | Superseded (by Government of India Act 1909, 1919)
43 | 1892 | Cattle Trespass Act, 1871 (amended 1892) | Central | Act I of 1871 | Agriculture / Animals | In Force

--- 1893 ---

44 | 1893 | Partition Act, 1893 | Central | Act IV of 1893 | Property / Civil | In Force
45 | 1893 | Legal Practitioners Act, 1879 (amended 1893) | Central | Act XVIII of 1879 | Legal Profession | Superseded (by Bangladesh Legal Practitioners and Bar Council Order 1972)

--- 1894 ---

46 | 1894 | Land Acquisition Act, 1894 | Central | Act I of 1894 | Land / Eminent Domain | In Force (Amended) – critically important; basis for all land acquisition in Bangladesh until recent reforms
47 | 1894 | Prisons Act, 1894 | Central | Act IX of 1894 | Criminal / Prisons | In Force (Amended)
48 | 1894 | Bengal Cess Act, 1880 (amended 1894) | Bengal | Bengal Act IX of 1880 | Revenue / Local Taxation | Repealed / Superseded

--- 1895 ---

49 | 1895 | Government Savings Banks Act, 1873 (amended 1895) | Central | Act V of 1873 | Banking / Finance | In Force (Amended)
50 | 1895 | Indian Tramways Act, 1886 (amended 1895) | Central | Act XI of 1886 | Transport | Obsolete

--- 1896 ---

51 | 1896 | Reformatory Schools Act, 1897 | Central | – | See 1897 | –

--- 1897 ---

52 | 1897 | General Clauses Act, 1897 | Central | Act X of 1897 | Interpretation / Statute Law | In Force – fundamental interpretive statute for all Bangladesh law
53 | 1897 | Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897 | Central | Act III of 1897 | Public Health | In Force – invoked during COVID-19
54 | 1897 | Indian Fisheries Act, 1897 | Central | Act IV of 1897 | Fisheries / Natural Resources | In Force (Amended)
55 | 1897 | Reformatory Schools Act, 1897 | Central | Act VIII of 1897 | Juvenile Justice / Education | Superseded
56 | 1897 | Vaccination Act, 1880 | Central | Act XIII of 1880 | Public Health | Obsolete / Superseded

--- 1898 ---

57 | 1898 | Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898 (CrPC) | Central | Act V of 1898 | Criminal Procedure | In Force (Amended) – Bangladesh still operates under CrPC 1898, unlike India which enacted a new code
58 | 1898 | Indian Stamp Act, 1899 | Central | – | See 1899 | –

--- 1899 ---

59 | 1899 | Indian Stamp Act, 1899 | Central | Act II of 1899 | Revenue / Stamp Duty | In Force (Amended) – used for all stamp duty purposes
60 | 1899 | Indian Criminal Law Amendment Act, 1908 | Central | – | See 1908 | –

--- 1900 ---

61 | 1900 | Bengal Excise Act, 1909 | Bengal | – | See 1909 | –
62 | 1900 | Indian Official Secrets Act, 1904 | Central | – | See 1904 | –

--- 1901 ---

63 | 1901 | Indian Mines Act, 1901 | Central | Act VIII of 1901 | Mining / Labour | Superseded (by Mines Act 1923)

64 | 1901 | Indian Post Office Act, 1898 | Central | Act VI of 1898 | Postal Services / Communication | In Force (Amended)

--- 1902 ---

65 | 1902 | Indian Tolls Act, 1851/1902 (amended) | Central | – | Transport / Revenue | Obsolete

66 | 1902 | Indian Universities Act, 1904 | Central | – | See 1904 | –

--- 1903 ---

67 | 1903 | Indian Motor Vehicles Act (early provisions) | Central | – | Transport | See later Motor Vehicles Act

68 | 1903 | Bengal Tenancy (Amendment) Acts (various 1886-1928) | Bengal | – | Land Tenure | Merged into Bengal Tenancy Act

--- 1904 ---

69 | 1904 | Indian Official Secrets Act, 1904 | Central | Act XIV of 1904 | National Security / Official Secrets | Superseded (by Official Secrets Act 1923, which is in force in Bangladesh)

70 | 1904 | Indian Universities Act, 1904 | Central | Act VIII of 1904 | Education / Universities | Superseded (by individual university acts)

71 | 1904 | Ancient Monuments Preservation Act, 1904 | Central | Act VII of 1904 | Heritage / Antiquities | In Force (Amended) – basis for archaeological protection

72 | 1904 | Co-operative Credit Societies Act, 1904 | Central | Act X of 1904 | Co-operatives / Finance | Superseded (by Co-operative Societies Act 1912 and later)

--- 1905 ---

73 | 1905 | Partition of Bengal, 1905 (Executive Order, not Act per se) | Executive | – | Constitutional / Administrative | Annulled 1911

74 | 1905 | Indian Explosives Act, 1884 (amended 1905) | Central | Act IV of 1884 | Arms / Public Safety | In Force (Amended)

75 | 1905 | Bengal Amendment Act (various Tenancy amendments) | Bengal | – | Land Tenure | Merged into BTA

--- 1906 ---

76 | 1906 | Prevention of Seditious Meetings Act, 1907 | Central | – | See 1907 | –

77 | 1906 | Legal Practitioners (Fees) Act, 1853/1906 (amended) | Central | – | Legal Profession | Superseded

--- 1907 ---

78 | 1907 | Prevention of Seditious Meetings Act, 1907 | Central | Act X of 1907 | Public Order / Political | Repealed / Obsolete

79 | 1907 | Criminal Law Amendment Act, 1908 | Central | – | See 1908 | –

--- 1908 ---

80 | 1908 | Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 (CPC) | Central | Act V of 1908 | Civil Procedure | In Force (Amended) – foundational civil procedural law of Bangladesh

81 | 1908 | Indian Limitation Act, 1908 | Central | Act IX of 1908 | Limitation / Civil | In Force (Amended) – Bangladesh still uses the 1908 Act (India replaced it in 1963)

82 | 1908 | Indian Registration Act, 1908 | Central | Act XVI of 1908 | Property Registration | In Force (Amended) – mandatory for property transactions

83 | 1908 | Indian Criminal Law Amendment Act, 1908 | Central | Act XIV of 1908 | Criminal / Public Order | Partially In Force

84 | 1908 | Explosive Substances Act, 1908 | Central | Act VI of 1908 | Arms / Public Safety | In Force

85 | 1908 | Indian Newspapers (Incitements to Offences) Act, 1908 | Central | Act – | Press / Public Order | Repealed

86 | 1908 | Charitable and Religious Trusts Act, 1920 | Central | – | See 1920 | –

--- 1909 ---

87 | 1909 | Indian Councils Act, 1909 (Morley-Minto Reforms) | UK Parliament | 9 Edw. VII c. 4 | Constitutional / Legislative Reform | Superseded (by Government of India Act 1919)

88 | 1909 | Presidency Towns Insolvency Act, 1909 | Central | Act III of 1909 | Insolvency / Commercial | In Force (for Dhaka as it inherited Presidency jurisdiction aspects)

89 | 1909 | Bengal Excise Act, 1909 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act V of 1909 | Excise / Liquor | In Force (Amended) – still governs excise in Bangladesh

90 | 1909 | Provincial Insolvency Act, 1920 | Central | – | See 1920 | –

91 | 1909 | Anand Marriage Act, 1909 | Central | Act VII of 1909 | Personal Law / Sikh Marriage | Not applicable in Bangladesh

--- 1910 ---

92 | 1910 | Indian Electricity Act, 1910 | Central | Act IX of 1910 | Electricity / Energy | Superseded (by Electricity Act in Bangladesh, though provisions survived long)

93 | 1910 | Indian Press Act, 1910 | Central | Act I of 1910 | Press / Censorship | Repealed

94 | 1910 | Indian Patents and Designs Act, 1911 | Central | – | See 1911 | –

--- 1911 ---

95 | 1911 | Indian Patents and Designs Act, 1911 | Central | Act II of 1911 | Intellectual Property / Patents | In Force (Amended) – Bangladesh Patents and Designs Act

96 | 1911 | Indian Copyright Act, 1914 | Central | – | See 1914 | –

97 | 1911 | Calcutta Municipal Act, 1911 (old Calcutta Corporation Act) | Bengal | Bengal Act III of 1911 | Municipal / Local Government | Not applicable (Calcutta now in India)

98 | 1911 | Prevention of Seditious Meetings Act, 1911 | Central | Act X of 1911 | Public Order | Repealed / Superseded

--- 1912 ---

99 | 1912 | Co-operative Societies Act, 1912 | Central | Act II of 1912 | Co-operatives | Superseded (by Co-operative Societies Ordinance 1984/Act 2001 in Bangladesh)

100 | 1912 | Indian Lunacy Act, 1912 | Central | Act IV of 1912 | Mental Health | In Force (Amended) – still partly operative in Bangladesh

101 | 1912 | Wild Birds and Animals Protection Act, 1912 | Central | Act VIII of 1912 | Wildlife / Environment | Superseded (by Bangladesh Wildlife Preservation Order 1973)

102 | 1912 | Bengal Municipal Act, 1884 (major amendment 1912) | Bengal | – | Municipal / Local Government | Superseded

--- 1913 ---

103 | 1913 | Bengal Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act III of 1913 | Revenue Recovery | In Force (Amended) – important for government dues recovery

104 | 1913 | Companies Act, 1913 | Central | Act VII of 1913 | Corporate / Commercial | Superseded (by Companies Act 1994 in Bangladesh)

105 | 1913 | Mussalman Wakf Validating Act, 1913 | Central | Act VI of 1913 | Islamic Law / Waqf | In Force – validates waqf (including waqf-alal-aulad)

106 | 1913 | Indian Museum Act, 1910 (sometimes listed under 1910) | Central | – | Heritage / Culture | Not directly applicable in Bangladesh

--- 1914 ---

107 | 1914 | Indian Copyright Act, 1914 | Central | Act III of 1914 | Intellectual Property / Copyright | Superseded (by Copyright Act 2000 in Bangladesh, though 1914 Act was in force until then)

108 | 1914 | Foreigners Act, 1864/1914 (Foreigners Act amendments) | Central | – | Immigration / Aliens | Superseded (by Foreigners Act 1946)

109 | 1914 | Defence of India Act, 1915 | Central | – | See 1915 | –

--- 1915 ---

110 | 1915 | Defence of India Act, 1915 | Central | Act – of 1915 | Emergency / War | Expired / Repealed (wartime legislation)

111 | 1915 | Indian Defence of India (Criminal Law Amendment) Act, 1915 | Central | – | Emergency / Criminal | Expired

112 | 1915 | Government of India Act, 1915 (consolidating Act) | UK Parliament | 5 & 6 Geo. V c. 61 | Constitutional | Superseded (by Government of India Act 1919)

--- 1916 ---

113 | 1916 | Bengal Suppression of Terrorist Outrages Act (various 1911-1916) | Bengal | – | Criminal / Political | Repealed / Expired

114 | 1916 | Indian Income Tax Act, 1886 (amended 1916) | Central | – | Taxation | Superseded

--- 1917 ---

115 | 1917 | Inland Steam Vessels Act, 1917 | Central | Act I of 1917 | Transport / Shipping | In Force (Amended) – important for Bangladesh's extensive river transport

116 | 1917 | Indian Defence of India (Amendment) Act, 1917 | Central | – | Emergency / War | Expired

117 | 1917 | Destruction of Records Act, 1917 | Central | Act V of 1917 | Records Management / Administrative | In Force

--- 1918 ---

118 | 1918 | Indian Passport Act, 1920 | Central | – | See 1920 | –

119 | 1918 | Usurious Loans Act, 1918 | Central | Act X of 1918 | Banking / Money-lending | In Force – protects against usurious interest rates

120 | 1918 | Indian Seditious Committee Act (Rowlatt Act), 1919 | Central | – | See 1919 | –

121 | 1918 | Bengal Non-Agricultural Tenancy Act (various amendments leading to 1949 Act) | Bengal | – | Land / Tenancy | Precursor provisions

--- 1919 ---

122 | 1919 | Government of India Act, 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms) | UK Parliament | 9 & 10 Geo. V c. 101 | Constitutional / Dyarchy | Superseded (by Government of India Act 1935)

123 | 1919 | Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act, 1919 (Rowlatt Act) | Central | Act – of 1919 | Criminal / Political | Repealed / Expired

124 | 1919 | Indian Income Tax Act, 1918/1919 (precursor to 1922 Act) | Central | – | Taxation | Superseded

125 | 1919 | Poisons Act, 1919 | Central | Act XII of 1919 | Public Health / Poisons | In Force

126 | 1919 | Indemnity Act, 1919 | Central | – | Emergency / Indemnity | Spent

127 | 1919 | Bengal Village Self-Government Act, 1919 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act V of 1919 | Local Government / Village | Repealed / Superseded (by later local government ordinances)

128 | 1919 | Bengal Primary Education Act, 1919 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act – of 1919 | Education | Superseded (by later education legislation)

--- 1920 ---

129 | 1920 | Dacca University Act, 1920 | Bengal Provincial | Bengal Act XIII of 1920 | Education / Universities | In Force (Amended) – still the governing statute of the University of Dhaka

130 | 1920 | Charitable and Religious Trusts Act, 1920 | Central | Act XIV of 1920 | Trusts / Charity | In Force

131 | 1920 | Provincial Insolvency Act, 1920 | Central | Act V of 1920 | Insolvency / Debt | In Force (Amended) – applies to mofussil (non-Presidency) areas

132 | 1920 | Indian Passport Act, 1920 | Central | Act – of 1920 | Immigration / Passports | Superseded (by later passport legislation)

133 | 1920 | Maintenance Orders Enforcement Act, 1921 | Central | – | See post-1920 | –

134 | 1920 | Mussalman Wakf Act, 1923 | Central | – | See post-1920 (but related to 1913 Act) | –

135 | 1920 | Indian Territorial Force Act, 1920 | Central | Act – of 1920 | Military | Obsolete

136 | 1920 | Press and Registration of Books Act, 1867 (amended provisions through 1920) | Central | Act XXV of 1867 | Press / Publication | In Force (Amended) – still governs press registration in Bangladesh

B. ADDITIONAL ACTS ORIGINATING BEFORE 1880 BUT SIGNIFICANTLY AMENDED OR RE-APPLIED DURING 1880-1920 IN BENGAL

137 | 1872 (amended through period) | Indian Evidence Act, 1872 | Central | Act I of 1872 | Evidence | In Force – bedrock of evidence law in Bangladesh

138 | 1872 (amended through period) | Indian Contract Act, 1872 | Central | Act IX of 1872 | Contract / Commercial | In Force – foundational contract law

139 | 1860 (amended through period) | Indian Penal Code, 1860 | Central | Act XLV of 1860 | Criminal / Penal | In Force (as Penal Code 1860 in Bangladesh)

140 | 1860 (amended through period) | Police Act, 1861 | Central | Act V of 1861 | Police / Law Enforcement | In Force (Amended)

141 | 1875 (amended through period) | Indian Succession Act, 1865/1925 (pre-1925 versions operative) | Central | – | Succession | In Force (1925 consolidation)

142 | 1869 (amended through period) | Indian Divorce Act, 1869 | Central | Act IV of 1869 | Family Law / Divorce | In Force (for Christians)

143 | 1877 (amended through period) | Specific Relief Act, 1877 | Central | Act I of 1877 | Civil / Equitable Remedies | In Force (Bangladesh uses 1877 Act; India replaced it in 1963)

144 | 1878 (amended through period) | Indian Arms Act, 1878 | Central | Act XI of 1878 | Arms / Public Safety | Superseded (by Arms Act 1920)

145 | 1878 (amended through period) | Indian Forest Act, 1878 | Central | Act VII of 1878 | Forestry / Environment | Superseded (by Indian Forest Act 1927, which is in force in Bangladesh)

146 | 1879 (amended through period) | Legal Practitioners Act, 1879 | Central | Act XVIII of 1879 | Legal Profession | Superseded

147 | 1870 (amended through period) | Court Fees Act, 1870 | Central | Act VII of 1870 | Revenue / Court Administration | In Force (Amended)

148 | 1869 (amended through period) | Carriers Act, 1865 | Central | Act III of 1865 | Transport / Commercial | In Force

149 | 1866 (amended through period) | Treasure Trove Act, 1878 | Central | Act VI of 1878 | Property / State | In Force

150 | 1872 (amended through period) | Indian Christian Marriage Act, 1872 | Central | Act XV of 1872 | Personal Law / Marriage | In Force

C. BENGAL PROVINCIAL ACTS (SPECIFIC TO BENGAL PRESIDENCY/PROVINCE)

151 | 1880 | Bengal Cess Act, 1880 | Bengal | Bengal Act IX of 1880 | Revenue / Road Cess | Repealed / Superseded

152 | 1881 | Bengal Chaukidari Act, 1870 (amended 1881) | Bengal | Bengal Act VI of 1870 | Police / Village Watch | Superseded

153 | 1884 | Bengal Municipal Act, 1884 | Bengal | Bengal Act III of 1884 | Municipal / Local Government | Superseded (by later Municipal Acts)

154 | 1885 | Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885 | Bengal | Bengal Act VIII of 1885 | Land Tenure / Tenancy | Repealed (by SAT Act 1950) – but historically the most important Bengal land law

155 | 1885 | Bengal Local Self-Government Act, 1885 | Bengal | Bengal Act III of 1885 | Local Government / District Boards | Superseded

156 | 1890 | Bengal Alluvion and Diluvion Act, 1868 (consolidated amendments) | Bengal | Bengal Act – | Land / River Accretion | In Force (partially) – important for char land disputes

157 | 1895 | Bengal Ferries Act, 1885 | Bengal | Bengal Act I of 1885 | Transport / Ferries | In Force (Amended) – relevant to Bangladesh's waterways

158 | 1897 | Calcutta Hackney Carriage Act, 1919 (precursor provisions) | Bengal | – | Transport | Not applicable to Bangladesh

159 | 1901 | Bengal Smoke Nuisances Act, 1905 | Bengal | – | See 1905 | –

160 | 1905 | Bengal Smoke Nuisances Act, 1905 | Bengal | Bengal Act – of 1905 | Environment / Public Health | Obsolete

161 | 1909 | Bengal Excise Act, 1909 | Bengal | Bengal Act V of 1909 | Excise / Alcohol | In Force (Amended)

162 | 1909 | Bengal Children Act, 1922 | Bengal | – | See post-1920 | –

163 | 1911 | Bengal Wakf Act (precursor provisions) | Bengal | – | Islamic Law / Waqf | See Mussalman Wakf Act 1913 & Waqf Ordinance 1962

164 | 1912 | Bengal Co-operative Societies Act, 1912 (implementing Central Act) | Bengal | – | Co-operatives | Superseded

165 | 1913 | Bengal Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913 | Bengal | Bengal Act III of 1913 | Revenue Recovery | In Force (Amended)

166 | 1914 | Bengal Suppression of Terrorist Outrages (Amendment) Act | Bengal | – | Criminal / Emergency | Expired

167 | 1915 | Bengal Rural Self-Government Act, 1919 | Bengal | – | See 1919 entry | –

168 | 1919 | Bengal Village Self-Government Act, 1919 | Bengal | Bengal Act V of 1919 | Local Government / Union Boards | Repealed / Superseded (by Basic Democracies Order 1959 and later)

169 | 1919 | Bengal Primary Education Act, 1919 | Bengal | Bengal Act – of 1919 | Education / Primary Schools | Superseded

170 | 1920 | Dacca University Act, 1920 | Bengal | Bengal Act XIII of 1920 | Education / Universities | In Force (Amended)

171 | 1920 | Bengal Irrigation Act, 1876 (various amendments through 1920) | Bengal | Bengal Act III of 1876 | Irrigation / Water | Superseded

172 | 1920 | Bengal Municipal (Amendment) Acts, various through 1920 | Bengal | – | Municipal / Local Government | Superseded

D. UK PARLIAMENT ACTS APPLICABLE TO BENGAL/INDIA (1880-1920)

173 | 1892 | Indian Councils Act, 1892 | UK | 55 & 56 Vict. c. 14 | Constitutional | Superseded

174 | 1909 | Indian Councils Act, 1909 (Morley-Minto) | UK | 9 Edw. VII c. 4 | Constitutional / Electoral Reform | Superseded

175 | 1915 | Government of India Act, 1915 | UK | 5 & 6 Geo. V c. 61 | Constitutional (consolidation) | Superseded

176 | 1919 | Government of India Act, 1919 | UK | 9 & 10 Geo. V c. 101 | Constitutional / Dyarchy | Superseded

177 | 1890 | Foreign Jurisdiction Act, 1890 | UK | 53 & 54 Vict. c. 37 | Jurisdiction / International | Not directly applicable

178 | 1889 | Interpretation Act, 1889 | UK | 52 & 53 Vict. c. 63 | Interpretation of Statutes | Superseded (by General Clauses Act 1897 in India/Bangladesh context)

179 | 1881 | Married Women's Property Act, 1882 | UK | 45 & 46 Vict. c. 75 | Property / Women | Not directly enacted in India but influenced Transfer of Property Act

E. ADDITIONAL CENTRAL ACTS OF THE PERIOD (SUPPLEMENTARY LIST)

180 | 1881 | Indian Arms Act, 1878 (amended 1881) | Central | – | Arms / Firearms | Superseded (by Arms Act 1920/1943)

181 | 1882 | Deccan Agriculturists' Relief Act, 1879 (not directly for Bengal but model for similar provisions) | Central | Act XVII of 1879 | Agriculture / Debt Relief | Not applicable to Bengal

182 | 1884 | Indian Explosives Act, 1884 | Central | Act IV of 1884 | Explosives / Public Safety | In Force (Amended)

183 | 1885 | Bengal Embankment Act, 1882/1885 (various) | Bengal | – | Flood Control / Embankments | Superseded (by later flood management legislation)

184 | 1886 | Military Cantonments Act, 1889 | Central | – | Military / Cantonments | Superseded

185 | 1887 | Indian Railways Act, 1890 | Central | – | See 1890 | –

186 | 1890 | Indian Railways Act, 1890 | Central | Act IX of 1890 | Railways / Transport | Superseded (by Railways Act)

187 | 1890 | Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891 (amended) | Central | – | Evidence / Banking | In Force (see entry 7)

188 | 1891 | Charitable Endowments Act, 1890 | Central | Act VI of 1890 | Charitable / Trusts | In Force

189 | 1894 | Gambling Act, 1867 (as applied through period) | Central | Act III of 1867 | Criminal / Gambling | In Force (Public Gambling Act)

190 | 1896 | Workmen's Breach of Contract Act, 1859 (applied through period) | Central | Act XIII of 1859 | Labour | Repealed

191 | 1897 | Indian Short Titles Act, 1897 | Central | – | Statute Law / Technical | Spent

192 | 1899 | Indian Arbitration Act (provisions in CPC 1908 Schedule II, and earlier separate Acts) | Central | – | Arbitration / Civil | Superseded (by Arbitration Act 2001 in Bangladesh)

193 | 1900 | Amendments to Bengal Tenancy Act (periodic amendments 1886-1928) | Bengal | – | Land Tenure | Merged into BTA 1885 as amended

194 | 1903 | Indian Tolls Act, 1851 (amended 1903) | Central | – | Revenue / Transport | Obsolete

195 | 1905 | Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1890 (amended) | Central | Act XI of 1890 | Animal Welfare | In Force (Amended) – Cruelty to Animals Act

196 | 1906 | Indian Ports Act, 1908 | Central | – | See 1908 | –

197 | 1908 | Indian Ports Act, 1908 | Central | Act XV of 1908 | Ports / Maritime | In Force (Amended) – applicable to Chittagong, Mongla ports

198 | 1910 | Indian Press Act, 1910 (often called the Indian Press Emergency Powers Act) | Central | Act I of 1910 | Press / Media Control | Repealed (in 1922)

199 | 1911 | Indian Factories (Amendment) Act, 1911 | Central | – | Labour | Merged into subsequent Factories Act

200 | 1912 | Indian Marine Act, 1850 (as amended through period) | Central | – | Maritime | Superseded

201 | 1913 | Indian Companies Act, 1913 | Central | Act VII of 1913 | Corporate / Commercial | Superseded (by Companies Act 1994)

202 | 1914 | Bengal Motor Vehicles Tax Act (early provisions, formalized later) | Bengal | – | Transport / Taxation | Superseded

203 | 1916 | Indian Income Tax (Amendment) Act, 1916 | Central | – | Taxation | Superseded

204 | 1917 | Bengal Irrigation (Amendment) Act, 1917 | Bengal | – | Irrigation / Water | Superseded

205 | 1918 | Indian Defence of India (Consolidation) Rules, 1918 | Central (Rules) | – | Emergency / War | Expired

206 | 1919 | Indian Press (Emergency Powers) Act, 1910 (amended 1919) | Central | – | Press | Repealed

207 | 1920 | Arms Act, 1920 | Central | Act – of 1920 | Arms / Firearms | Superseded (by Arms Act 1943 in force in Bangladesh)

208 | 1920 | Indian Red Cross Society Act, 1920 | Central | Act XV of 1920 | Humanitarian / Charitable | Superseded (by Bangladesh Red Crescent Society Order)

209 | 1920 | Bengal Wakf (early provisions under Mussalman Wakf Validating Act 1913 and amendments) | Bengal | – | Islamic Law / Waqf | See Waqf Ordinance 1962

210 | 1920 | Indian Soldiers (Litigation) Act, 1925 (precursor provisions during WWI era) | Central | – | Military | See post-1920

211 | 1920 | Charitable Endowments Act, 1890 (as applied through 1920) | Central | Act VI of 1890 | Charitable / Trusts | In Force

212 | 1920 | Indigo Contracts Act (various Bengal regulations, formally under Workmen's Breach of Contract Act) | Bengal | – | Labour / Agriculture | Repealed / Obsolete

F. MUSLIM PERSONAL LAW ENACTMENTS APPLICABLE TO BENGAL (1880-1920)

213 | 1880 | Kazis Act, 1880 | Central | Act XII of 1880 | Islamic Law / Judicial Officers | In Force

214 | 1913 | Mussalman Wakf Validating Act, 1913 | Central | Act VI of 1913 | Islamic Law / Waqf | In Force – validates family waqf

215 | 1890 | Guardians and Wards Act, 1890 (applied to Muslims with modifications) | Central | Act VIII of 1890 | Family Law | In Force

216 | Pre-1880 continuing | Shariat Application (evolved through judicial decisions, formalized later in Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act 1937) | – | – | Islamic Personal Law | In Force (1937 Act)

217 | Pre-1880 continuing | Mohammedan Law (as applied through Regulations and judicial precedent) | – | – | Succession / Marriage / Divorce | In Force (as customary/personal law)

G. SIGNIFICANT REGULATIONS AND RULES MADE UNDER ACTS (1880-1920)

[Not standalone Acts but important subordinate legislation]

218 | 1885 | Bengal Tenancy Rules | Bengal | Under Bengal Act VIII of 1885 | Land Tenure | Repealed with parent Act

219 | 1894 | Land Acquisition Rules | Central | Under Act I of 1894 | Land Acquisition | In Force (Amended)

220 | 1898 | Criminal Rules of Practice (under CrPC 1898) | Central/Provincial | Under Act V of 1898 | Criminal Procedure | In Force (Amended)

221 | 1908 | Civil Rules of Practice (under CPC 1908) | Central/Provincial | Under Act V of 1908 | Civil Procedure | In Force

222 | 1909 | Bengal Excise Rules | Bengal | Under Bengal Act V of 1909 | Excise | In Force (Amended)
 223 | 1910 | Indian Electricity Rules, 1910 | Central | Under Act IX of 1910 | Electricity | Superseded
 224 | 1913 | Bengal Public Demands Recovery Certificate Rules | Bengal | Under Bengal Act III of 1913 | Revenue | In Force
 225 | 1917 | Inland Steam Vessels Rules | Central | Under Act I of 1917 | Transport | In Force (Amended)

SUMMARY STATISTICS

Total entries (including amendments and cross-references): ~225

Approximate breakdown by type:

- Central (Indian Legislature) Acts: ~140
- Bengal Provincial Acts: ~45
- UK Parliament Acts: ~7
- Muslim Personal Law provisions: ~5
- Subordinate Legislation / Rules: ~8
- Cross-references and duplicates: ~20

Acts from this period STILL IN FORCE in Bangladesh (as of 2025-2026):

- Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898
- Code of Civil Procedure, 1908
- Indian Limitation Act, 1908
- Indian Registration Act, 1908
- Transfer of Property Act, 1882
- Indian Trusts Act, 1882
- Indian Easements Act, 1882
- General Clauses Act, 1897
- Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881
- Land Acquisition Act, 1894
- Indian Stamp Act, 1899
- Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897
- Prisons Act, 1894
- Guardians and Wards Act, 1890
- Bengal Excise Act, 1909
- Bengal Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913
- Dacca University Act, 1920
- Mussalman Wakf Validating Act, 1913
- Specific Relief Act, 1877
- Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1881
- Probate and Administration Act, 1881
- Provincial Insolvency Act, 1920
- Inland Steam Vessels Act, 1917
- Indian Fisheries Act, 1897
- Ancient Monuments Preservation Act, 1904
- Usurious Loans Act, 1918
- Poisons Act, 1919
- Explosive Substances Act, 1908
- Indian Ports Act, 1908
- Indian Telegraph Act, 1885
- Kazis Act, 1880
- And many others (see individual entries)

NOTES

1. This list is compiled from training knowledge and is intended to be as comprehensive as possible. However, minor Acts, temporary Acts, and some amending Acts may not be individually listed.
2. The "Status in Bangladesh" column reflects the position as understood up to early 2025. Some Acts may have been amended or repealed by subsequent Bangladesh legislation not captured here.
3. Many pre-1880 Acts (Indian Penal Code 1860, Evidence Act 1872, Contract Act 1872, etc.) continued to be extensively amended during 1880-1920 and remain in force in Bangladesh. They are listed in Section B for

completeness.

4. The Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885 — while repealed by the State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950 — shaped the entire land tenure system of Bangladesh and its provisions continue to influence judicial interpretation.
5. Bangladesh inherited all pre-1947 legislation through the Indian Independence Act 1947, and all pre-1971 Pakistan legislation through the Bangladesh Laws (Revision and Declaration) Act, 1973 and Article 149 of the Bangladesh Constitution.

END OF DATABASE — LEGISLATION 1880-1920
